# Zackary Mark

Student Advocate · Sun Prairie West High School · 2026 at a glance

Since January 2026 I've pushed for student voice in the Sun Prairie Area School District and for plain-language transparency about the city's license plate reader cameras. I run two independent projects: **SPASD Student Voice** (spasdstudentvoice.netlify.app, @spasdstudentvoice) and **Sun Prairie ALPR** (sunprairiealpr.netlify.app, @sunprairiealpr). The full record, with every email, meeting and document, runs about 260 pages and is available on request.

## Where things stand (November 10, 2026)

- **Won — newsletters to every student.** Asked for at the Oct 20 meeting; the district confirmed in writing on Oct 21 that newsletters will go to students starting in November.
- **Answered in writing — LGBTQIA+ protections unchanged** (Oct 1).
- **Won — students in the room for leadership hiring.** Students sat on the SPWHS principal interviews and met the superintendent finalists (April).
- **Won — a Student Senate restart** at Sun Prairie West, with students elected in April.
- **Moving — weighted grades.** Students helped write the plan and four of them previewed it with Board members on Nov 2. Next: student rehearsal and Board meeting Nov 9, a follow-up with district and school leaders Nov 17, final vote expected late November.
- **Building — a District-Wide Student Council.** Proposed to Superintendent Dr. Reed on Oct 29 ("I love this idea"), discussed with him in person Nov 4, then opened to every middle and high school, grades 6–12. Patrick Marsh signed on Nov 5 with 3–5 Peer Ambassadors, Prairie Phoenix's principal wrote that he is supportive, and Sun Prairie East offered its weekly newsletter and SP30, then said on Nov 10 it can't share the invitation until the council is school-sponsored. Still open: how a district-level group registers and who sponsors it.
- **Answered — how Board student reps are chosen.** Two-year terms; recruiting starts in December, applications open mid-January for sophomores.
- **Answered in writing — license plate readers.** SPPD's written FAQ (Oct 16) and the Chief's Oct 27 answers: a 14-day Axon retention trial, no livestreaming, monthly audits, and a public data-sharing MOU after signing. These are department statements, not contract terms yet.
- **Asked in writing — plate reader records.** Public records request for the Axon estimate, Policy F-18, data-sharing agreements and audit records, filed Nov 9. The Chief also said he's open to a quarterly transparency report once Axon is approved.
- **Waiting — the Mayor.** Meeting requested Oct 2.

## The year in one page

- **Jan 13** — Student Safety & Trust Framework sent to the Board of Education.
- **Jan 26** — Act 95 students present survey findings at a public hearing.
- **Feb 26** — Weighted grades work group begins.
- **Mar 2** — Student advocacy meeting with school and district leaders.
- **April** — Principal interviews, superintendent candidate session (Apr 13), Student Senate elected (Apr 27), Report A published.

- **Jul 10** — First meeting with Chief Warych about Flock cameras.
- **August** — Meetings on the budget (Aug 18), with Dr. Turner (Aug 27) and with the Chief (Aug 17).
- **Sept 23** — Weighted grades work group restarts for 2026–27.
- **Oct 1** — District confirms in writing that LGBTQIA+ protections are unchanged.
- **Oct 6–7** — Community ALPR report sent to the Chief; Public Safety Committee hears the Axon plan.
- **Oct 16** — SPPD sends a written ALPR FAQ.
- **Oct 20–22** — Meeting with district leaders, newsletter commitment, caregiver survey analysis.
- **Oct 27–29** — Chief's written answers, two new Instagram series, advisory council proposal to Dr. Reed.
- **Oct 30** — Dr. Reed: "I love this idea."
- **Nov 2** — Students preview weighted grades with the Board's Teaching & Learning Committee.
- **Nov 3** — Outreach to five more schools.
- **Nov 3** — The district publishes a feature on Zackary's advocacy, "Making a Difference Through Student Voice."
- **Nov 4** — Meeting with Dr. Reed; District-Wide Student Council invitations go to every middle and high school.
- **Nov 5** — Patrick Marsh signs on; Prairie Phoenix supportive.
- **Nov 6** — East offers to share the invitation; The district's Nov 3 newsletter feature, "Making a Difference Through Student Voice," added; follow-ups to the Board President, Dr. Morgan, the Chief and the Mayor.
- **Nov 7** — Letter to the Board of Education with questions about the superintendent's license.
- **Nov 8–9** — Zackary sent East an SP30 slide and poster; public records request and letter to the editor on plate readers; Chief open to a quarterly transparency report.
- **Nov 9** — Weighted grades plan goes to the Board's Committee of the Whole.
- **Nov 10** — Central Heights points the council to its Student Council; caregiver survey analysis released for the public record.
- **Coming up** — Nov 12 Patrick Marsh planning meeting, Nov 17 weighted grades follow-up and city budget approval, late November weighted grades vote.

## About me

I'm not part of a formal organization. I do this on my own and alongside other students because I think young people should be able to understand the decisions that affect them and ask questions of the people who make them.

Outside of advocacy, I teach martial arts at Kicks Unlimited in Sun Prairie, speak English and Spanish, and compete on the SPWHS Forensics team. I plan to become a social studies teacher.

## Contact

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